

His Excellency Dr. Dmitri Alexandrakis,
Honorable ambassador of Greece to Iran,
Heartfelt greetings and salutations,

Please be advised that dialogues between the Center for Interreligious Dialogue and Greek Christian scholars date back to many years ago. These dialogues initiated by the Center for Interreligious Dialogue and the Iran-Greece Friendship Society which was composed of a group of religious and academic scholars of University of Athens and some priests who had academic relations in addition to their church ties.

It is worth mentioning that the Greek Orthodox Church has always contributed to various meetings and dialogues of this kind. The first round of these dialogues was held under the theme of “Culture, Man and Environment” in 1990 in Athens. Then four rounds of dialogues were held in 1992, 1995, 1997 and 2000 in Athens, Tehran, Athens and Tehran respectively. The themes of these dialogues were as follows in sequence; The Faithful Man in the Changing Modern Day, the World and Hereinafter from the Islamic and Orthodox Christian Perspectives, Family and its Institutional Value from Islamic and Orthodox Christian Perspectives, and; Peaceful Coexistence among Cultures from Islamic and Orthodox Christian Perspectives.

Then, there was some lengthy lapse in dialogues but fortunately they were revived in 2016 when the sixth round of these dialogues was held in Tehran under the theme of “Religious Intellectuality: Solution to Fight Violence and Extremism”. This dialogue was an academic one. Since then six rounds of these dialogues have been held; three in Tehran and three in Athens.

The seventh round of these dialogues is supposed to be held in Alexandroupoli on 26-29 April, 2018 under the theme of “Ethical and Humanistic Values as Perceived by Quran and Bible”. A high-ranking Iranian delegation headed by the president of Islamic Culture and

Relations Organization and the head of the Council for Religious Policy-making, Dr. Aboozar Ebrahimi Torkaman would be dispatched to attend these meetings. Other members of the delegation are as follows;

1. Dr. Ahmad Moballeghi, a member of the Assembly of Experts and the president of the Research Center of the Islamic Consultative Assembly (Iranian Parliament).

2. Dr. Abdolhosein Khosropanah, the head of the Iranian Philosophical Society.

3. Dr. Elyas Arefzadeh, the head of the Abrahamic religious department, University of Religions and Denominations in Qom.

4. Ms. Zahra Rashidbeigi, the head of the Orthodox and Protestant Christian Department at the Center for Interreligious Dialogue.

5. Mr. Mohammadreza Ebrahimi Kiaie, the head of the PR department of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization.

Appreciating your excellency for assisting organization of this round of dialogues aiming at familiarizing two friendly nations and states of Greece and Iran, we hereby express our readiness to expand cultural and religious cooperation with your esteemed embassy.

Dr. Mohammad mehdi Taskhiri

President of the Center for Interreligious Dialogue

Islamic Culture and Relations Organization